

Ritvika Bal

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EDUCATION

The Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA *May 2029 (Expected)*

Candidate for Bachelor of Science in Economics, Concentration in Accounting and Finance

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.70/4.00
- **Honors & Organizations:** Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA@Penn), Campaign for Working Families (CFW), Successful Transition and Empowerment Program (STEP), Wharton Global Youth Program, Social Deduction Club (SDC)

Dallastown Area High School, Dallastown, PA

June 2025

- **GPA:** 3.9/4.0
- **Honors & Organizations:** Gold President's Volunteer Service Award, Mu Alpha Theta Member (Math National Honor Society), National Honor Society Member, Future Leaders of York Representative, York County Alliance of Learning Ambassador, HOBY Ambassador, Rotary International Representative, Dallastown School Board Student Representative

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) Program | *Advanced Tax Preparer*, Philadelphia, PA *January 2023 – Present*

- Conducted in-depth interviews with 50+ diverse clients to accurately assess income, deductions, and specialized credits
- Prepared and electronically filed 50+ tax returns, ensuring 100% compliance with current IRS regulations
- Reimbursed low-income and disadvantaged families with more than \$15,000 in tax refunds

Flickingers & Co., LLC | *Accounting Intern*, York, PA

June 2023 – July 2024

- Facilitated preparation and review of tax documentation for 5+ commercial client records during peak tax season
- Composed 3 marketing presentations to support client acquisition and community outreach initiatives
- Collaborated with a team of 6 CPAs to streamline advanced business tax returns

Prolifix Accounting & Tax Services, Inc. | *One-on-One Accounting Intern*, Hightstown, New Jersey

January 2023 – January 2024

- Worked alongside a CPA in the private sector, gaining exposure to client engagements and firm operations
- Supported 3+ client projects and administrative processes, developing a deeper understanding of business accounting practices
- Handled 2 cases of depreciation and managed company assets and records

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

VITA@Penn | *Community Outreach Chair*, Philadelphia, PA

April 2026 – Present

- Oversaw 730+ volunteer hours, 480+ taxpayers served, and \$665k in refunds to families during the Spring 2026 tax season
- Drove organization growth and outreach by successfully onboarding 80+ members within a semester

Forever Flowers | *Nonprofit Founder*, York, PA

August 2021 – Present

- Founded the nonprofit built to let cancer patients experience the beauty of flowers again
- Created over 4,000 individual paper flowers to give to immuno-compromised patients over the past 5 years
- Raised more than \$6,000 from sales to finance the organization and give back to the patients

BLOOM Business Empowerment Center | *Student Volunteer*, York, PA

January 2023 – June 2025

- Directly helped create opportunities for 30 underserved entrepreneurs through engagement events
- Assisted with handling micro-grants and financing start-ups and growth capital to strengthen local entrepreneurs

FINANCE & BUSINESS TRAINING

Boston Leadership Institute – Investment Banking Program, *Student*, Waltham, MA

Summer 2022

- Engaged with core investment banking concepts while learning from field experienced investment bankers and professors
- Tackled multiple case studies and real-life stimulations of public equity spending to build a diversified portfolio

Fordham University, Gabelli School of Business, *Student*, New York, NY

Summer 2022

- Acquired in-depth knowledge covering the organizations that make up the Wall Street ecosystem
- Learned global finance fundamentals through sessions with industry professionals and Gabelli School alumni.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

World Scholars Academy, *Co-Author*, Remote

Summer 2024

- Worked jointly with world-leading experts across the fields of economics and finance to expand my knowledge in cross-cultural negotiations and co-authored a research paper titled "[A Dyadic Regional Review of Cross-Cultural Negotiation](#)"

SKILLS

Technical: Market Research, Cross Functional Collaboration, Project Planning, Video Editing Software

Languages: Fluent English, Working Fluency Spanish (Spoken and Written), Fluent Hindi (Spoken), Fluent Gujarati (Spoken)

Interests: Economic Policy | Graphic Design | Reading | Music | Board Games | Taekwondo